

7 WEEKS OLD Your baby is beginning to discover his hands, you may notice him gazing at them and moving his fingers. This is the start of hand-eye coordination. He may bring his hands toward his mouth to explore them. His eye muscles have developed enough so that his eyes can now move in unison. Cooing and gurgling can start around now, as your baby realizes that he has a voice!

What you can do: Try dangling objects over him—just within swiping reach—as he lies on his back.

8 WEEKS OLD Your baby's back and neck muscles are now strong enough for him to hold his head in the midline of his body when he is lying on his back. Try holding your baby under his armpits and letting him bat his feet against the floor. Some babies are able to bear a little weight on their legs at this stage.

What you can do: Give your baby plenty of space to move, stretch out, and build strength in those growing muscles.

9 WEEKS OLD Your baby is becoming more social. He recognizes his parents and responds to your attention. He is beginning to associate people with fun and playtime.

What you can do: Your baby already loves your voice, but try using varied tones and interesting facial expressions. Copy your baby's coos to help him learn that the art of conversation is better with two!



10 WEEKS OLD The ability to calm and soothe himself is an important skill for your baby to learn and it may be developing by around 10 weeks. You may notice that your baby can cope with higher levels of stimulation. He may have figured out how to bring his hands together in front of his face or body.

What you can do: Sing nursery rhymes to your baby. He'll be transfixed by the rhythm and the stanzas will help him begin to understand the complexities of language and speech.

11 WEEKS OLD Your baby is beginning to recognize objects, such as his bottle or the movements you make to prepare for breast-feeding, and will show signs of eagerness to feed. He is also able to connect sounds with the object that makes them.

What you can do: Try making a sensory box filled with items of different colors and textures that can make different sounds, such as crinkly paper, rustling foil, and rattles. Put them in your baby's hands so that he can explore them.

12 WEEKS OLD By now, your baby is really starting to communicate with you. You may hear coos, squeals, and even a little babbling. Your baby may start reaching out to grab things with intent, rather than simply grasping what's handed to him. Your baby's digestive system is fully matured now. Your baby's giggles begin around now—a sure sign that he thinks you're funny!

What you can do: Try incorporating gentle movement with nursery rhymes.

14–18

The number of hours that your baby will sleep during a 24-hour period.

6 million

There are some six million cells on every square centimeter of a newborn's skin.

4 reflexes

Your newborn baby has four natural reflexes at birth: startle, rooting, grasping, and stepping.